Art-deco style bowl

Dear Mark,
I was inspired to make these bowls by the article in your November issue of Woodturning by Bob Chapman and the Art-Deco style bowl. I have been a keen amateur for about six years and I thought 'wouldn't it be interesting to have a curved feature in a bowl?'. So I decided to use leather as an insert. The light coloured bowl is lime (*Tilia vulgaris*) inserted with leather from a belt bought in a charity shop. The second bowl is walnut (*Juglans nigra)* with leather from an old drive belt. Both bowls are about 14cm in diameter.

Yours sincerely, Ian Ward

Worcestershire Woodturners

Hello Mark,
Regarding your editorial in the December Woodturning on clubs, I am the chairman of Worcestershire Woodturners (you have met a lot of us in the past). We meet on the first and third Monday of the month. One regular evening programme is a gallery and project, the gallery is made up of any items that members wish to show off, but the project is defined – the last was a piece of fruit, where we had anything from an apple to a bunch of bananas and a bowl of fruit with grapes and plums. A small trophy is presented annually, to the most productive member in each class. We encourage members to also bring along failures/disasters to teach/warn others of what can go wrong.

We have four lathes at our venue, so that we are able to have a hands on session with a common set piece for the evening. We also have three events each year where members can display their work and sell if they wish. A percentage is donated to our chosen charity – which for the last two years was The Midlands Air Ambulance – the last cheques presented to them were over £1,000 so you can see our members are quite productive. If anyone is interested in visiting or joining us, our venue is Droitwich Spa High School, WR9 0AA. www.worcestershirewoodturners.co.uk.

Ivor Gissing

FROM THE FORUM

Here we share with you the pieces that readers have posted on our Woodturning forum. If you are interested in the possibility of your piece appearing here, or would simply like feedback and advice on your work, visit **www.woodworkersinstitute.com** and click on the forum button.

Pete's vase stands at 355 x 190mm. The outside is finished with Krylon matte clear spray bomb and the inside is finished with coloured epoxy, to make it waterproof. The vase was turned green and textured with sandblasting. Fellow forum visitor Kiwi (Pete) said this of the piece: "Lovely piece Pete. The sandblasting finish has given it a very nice texture (want to pick it up look) and the uneven line on the inside neck gives the appearance of a richly glazed pottery piece."

Textured Ash Vase by Pete in Welland

Yew Vase by Dunkhooper

This is the deepest turning Dunkhooper has undertaken, at 130 x 120mm in Irish yew (*Taxus baccata*). Dunkhooper says of the piece: "There was a hole going right down the centre of the log, hence the hole in the bottom." The vase was very well recieved, with comments including 'nothing like a bit of yew' from Edbanger.

Edbanger's 'Wormy' is made using a little horse chestnut (*Aesculus hippocastanum*) burr, coloured with chestnut spirit stains and finished with cyanoacrylate. It measures 135 x 120mm. Again Kiwi (Pete) comments on the piece, saying: "Wow! I do like that Ed. It's what I would probably call a 'character piece'. Wonderful job on the colouring, it really makes the timber pop."

Wormy by Edbanger

Pen by Neil Lawton

In his post, Neil points out that he hasn't had much time to turn recently, but has bought a new lathe and just had to try it out! Neil made up two kits in Pissards purple plum (*Prunus cerasifera*) and one in burr sycamore (*Acer pseudoplatanus*). Forum user Dalboy commented: "A great job on all three, Neil. I especially like the Omega."

WT_290_8_9_Community_LettersVSBD.indd 9 03/02/2016 14:56